ENG-0022: Postmortem Analysis of identity-gateway System Incidents

Impact

The identity-gateway system, designated as SYS-043, is classified with medium criticality. Recent incidents have underscored vulnerabilities related to human error, resulting in operational disruptions. Specifically, two incidents—INC-036 and INC-052—were reported by E-173, each classified as Sev4 severity. The resolution times for these incidents were 61.5 and 62.5 hours, respectively. These disruptions have potential implications for Project Drift, the owning project, which was completed on the start date of 2025-02-17.

Timeline

- **Incident INC-036** was reported by E-173, with a resolution time of 61.5 hours.
- **Incident INC-052** followed, also reported by E-173, with a resolution time of 62.5 hours.
- Both incidents occurred within a similar timeframe, highlighting recurring issues related to human error in the identity-gateway system.
- The system is maintained by Brenda Hall, the on-call employee serving as Legal Counsel, based in Brisbane.
- The project lead for Project Drift, which owns the identity-gateway system, is David Wright, a Procurement Specialist located in Singapore.

Root Cause

Analysis indicates that the root cause for both INC-036 and INC-052 was human error. These errors contributed significantly to the system disruptions, emphasizing the need for targeted process improvements and additional training to mitigate such risks.

Action Items

- Review and enhance operational procedures related to identity-gateway management.
- Implement additional training sessions for personnel involved in system operations, with a focus on human error mitigation.
- Conduct a comprehensive review of incident response protocols to reduce resolution times.
- Engage Brenda Hall and David Wright to oversee the implementation of these corrective measures, leveraging their respective expertise in legal and procurement domains.

This postmortem underscores the importance of continuous process improvement to ensure the resilience of the identity-gateway system within Project Drift. Further monitoring and proactive measures are recommended to prevent recurrence of similar incidents.